ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 11: **The Thief's Story (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** a thief is reformed by the trust of the man he planned to rob	Intended victim becomes saviour.
2	**(c)** compassionate understanding	He is gentle with the thief.
3	**(d)** reform	Reform implies improvement.
4	**(a)** a reliable and sympathetic narrator	Candour wins sympathy.
5	**(b)** we imagine Hari's future after the lessons	It points to what comes next.
6	**(d)** betrays a friend and then repents	The idea is twisted.
7	**(b)** the transforming power of trust	Trust drives the plot.
8	**(a)** trust and redemption	Core themes.
9	**(b)** interior monologue	Direct thoughts.
10	**(a)** shaped by circumstance and open to change	Hari can change.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It suggests a crime story told by the criminal (1) but the tale becomes a story of reform, which surprises us (1).	1+1
12	It offers Hari an easy escape (1) and by not boarding he chooses a moral path over flight (1).	1+1
13	Hari might escape with the money (1), which would make the story a cynical crime tale and would lose the theme of redemption (1).	1+1
14	It allows Hari to repent freely without shame in front of Anil (1) and preserves the trust that effects the change (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The plain words and short sentences keep the tale close to Hari's voice. They avoid melodrama so that the moral emerges quietly. The simple style makes the profound idea of redemption more moving.	1+1+1
16	Meeting Anil at the wrestling match is chance. However the decision to return is Hari's own. Chance gives the opportunity; character decides the outcome.	1+1+1
17	He is frank and slightly humorous about his skills as a thief. He does not excuse himself. Yet when he speaks of Anil his tone becomes gentle and respectful.	1+1+1
	OR: Anil's trust drives the change and is the moral centre. But the story is told by Hari and traces his inner journey. Anil is the agent, Hari the protagonist, so the story is mainly Hari's.	1+1+1
18	The proverb says character never changes. Hari proves the opposite by changing after receiving trust. The story therefore challenges the proverb with a hopeful view.	1+1+1
	OR: Is it right to trust a stranger? Can a thief be reformed? Should society punish or educate? The story answers by favouring compassion and education.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Introduce redemption (1). Hari's initial intent to rob (1). Anil's trust and promise (1). Hari's conflict and return (1). Evaluation: believable and hopeful (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Friend's persuasion (1). Hari's hesitation (1). Anil's trust as reply (1). Hari's decision (1).	2+2+1
20	Match: confident, calculating, seeking a victim (1). Station: troubled, thoughtful (1). Cause of change: Anil's trust (1). Language of thought and action (1). Conclusion on character growth (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Exposition: Hari meets Anil (1). Rising action: job, promise, plan (1). Climax: station (1). Resolution: money returned (1). Effect of structure (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Hari Singh is a student; he is a **fifteen-year-old thief**, narrating in the first person, who tries to rob the writer Anil.
- Mixing Anil's response: he offers Hari **food, work and lessons**, and when Hari returns the notes Anil quietly shows he knows, without exposing him.
- Forgetting the notes episode: Hari puts the notes back under Anil's mattress; *this* is the moral turning point of the story.
- Treating money as Hari's only motive; he also wants to become a **respected, educated man**, which draws him to Anil.
- Saying Anil caught him and called the police; the story ends in **trust**, with Anil handing him a wet fifty-rupee note.
- Spelling slips: *Ruskin Bond, thief, Anil, wrestler, mattress*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 11: **The Thief's Story (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** Kindness conquers all	Kindness conquers wrongdoing here.
2	**(b)** Society gains more by reforming than by condemning	Thematic reading.
3	**(b)** an inner conflict	Man against himself.
4	**(a)** Hari's inner conflict	Only Hari knows his mind.
5	**(a)** the theme of redemption would fail	The change is the heart of the tale.
6	**(c)** His trust was risky but justified in the end	A balanced view.
7	**(a)** he returns the money secretly without gain	No reward is sought.
8	**(c)** complex plot with many twists	Plot is simple.
9	**(a)** changes during the story	Dynamic characters change.
10	**(d)** Anil's carelessness about money	He was trusting about valuables.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	For Hari money is the aim of life (1); for Anil it is a means and trust matters more (1).	1+1
12	Punishment would not have taught Hari to value honesty (1) whereas trust and education reached his conscience (1).	1+1
13	He had no education and no guidance (1) so crime was his only trade; yet he still chose to steal, so he is partly responsible (1).	1+1
14	It teaches by example not by lecture (1) and the narrator never judges; the lesson emerges from events (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Anil takes responsibility for a stranger instead of ignoring him. He gives a job and education, which society denied Hari. The story suggests that reform needs people willing to help.	1+1+1
16	We do not see Hari's future but understand it. His wish to learn and Anil's promise suggest a better life. The open ending leaves the reader hopeful and thoughtful.	1+1+1
17	Money may be spent or stolen but learning cannot be taken. Education changes how one lives. Anil gives Hari the means to earn honestly.	1+1+1
	OR: Hari waits until Anil sleeps. The reader wonders whether he will steal and flee. The scene at the station builds tension until his decision to return gives relief.	1+1+1
18	The mattress and money symbolise temptation and trust. The railway station symbolises the choice between flight and change. Anil's promise of lessons symbolises a new life.	1+1+1
	OR: Guilt is painful but it is also the sign of a growing conscience. Hari's guilt leads to the right decision. Thus guilt becomes the first step in his moral growth.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Hari is poor and uneducated (1). Punishment alone would harden him (1). Anil's compassion reforms him (1). Education offers a new path (1). The story calls for reform over revenge (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Statement of the idea (1). Hari's background (1). His moral decision (1). The role of kindness (1). The story's message (1).	2+2+1
20	Introduction (1). Hari's lack of education (1). Anil's promise (1). Wider examples (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Headline (1). Date and place (1). What happened (1). Quotes from witnesses (1). Concluding line (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Hari Singh is a student; he is a **fifteen-year-old thief**, narrating in the first person, who tries to rob the writer Anil.

- Mixing Anil's response: he offers Hari **food, work and lessons**, and when Hari returns the notes Anil quietly shows he knows, without exposing him.
- Forgetting the notes episode: Hari puts the notes back under Anil's mattress; *this* is the moral turning point of the story.
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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 11: **The Thief's Story (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** a collocation	Words that naturally go together.
2	**(d)** his nature stays constant	His goodness remains.
3	**(c)** Hari's change is quick and rests on a single incident	A fair critical point.
4	**(d)** salvation from wrongdoing	Being saved from a fault.
5	**(d)** temptation tested against trust	It tests Hari.
6	**(d)** If Anil had doubted him, Hari would have run away.	Third conditional.
7	**(b)** judgement	Trust may be called naive.
8	**(d)** metaphor	Direct comparison without 'like'.
9	**(c)** complex	One main and one subordinate clause.
10	**(d)** focus attention on the moral drama	No distractions.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A writer understands people and values words and learning (1) so he is the right person to offer Hari the gift of literacy (1).	1+1
12	He shows Hari's doubts and slow struggle (1) and links the change to a clear cause, Anil's trust and promise of learning (1).	1+1
13	We hear his fears and hopes directly (1) and see his humanity beneath the crime (1).	1+1
14	Others would label Hari a thief and nothing more (1) but Anil sees a boy with potential and refuses to judge him by his past (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He chooses to rob a kind man, so he is responsible. But his upbringing gave him few options. The writer asks us to judge him with understanding but also to see his ability to choose well.	1+1+1
16	Hari will not change unless Anil trusts him. 'Unless' means 'if not' and so the sentence expresses the same condition.	1+1+1
17	A dim room with Anil asleep. Hari enters quietly, speaks his thoughts aloud and slips the money under the mattress. He sits down, relieved, and the light fades.	1+1+1
	OR: Hari reads Anil as an easy victim, but Anil proves to be a moral teacher. Anil too might have judged Hari as a thief but chose trust. First impressions can mislead.	1+1+1
18	Hari, who is a thief, narrates the story. The relative pronoun 'who' links the two sentences.	1+1+1
	OR: He believes that people are basically capable of goodness. Even a thief can respond to love and trust. The story is gently optimistic.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Defines first person (1). Hari's honest account (1). Insight into his conflict (1). Limitations: Anil seen only from outside (1). Verdict (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Hari values wealth at first (1). Anil is poor but morally rich (1). Hari finds value in trust (1). He returns the money (1). Moral richness proves greater (1).	2+2+1
20	State your view (1). Trust was a risk (1). It produced reform (1). Counter view: trust may be abused (1). Balanced conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Address and date (1). Greeting and thanks (1). Account of education and work (1). Reflection on that night (1). Closing and name (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Hari Singh is a student; he is a **fifteen-year-old thief**, narrating in the first person, who tries to rob the writer Anil.
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